

THEA 210: Playwriting and Narrative Dramaturgy

Term: Fall 2026 | Instructor: Prof. Arthur Miller (amiller@arts.theatre.edu)

Course Description & Overview:

Craft of dramatic storytelling: dramatic action, character motivation, subtextual dialogue, three-act structure, and stage direction.

COURSE ASSIGNMENTS & WEIGHT DISTRIBUTION

Assignment Description	Weight	Due Module	Deliverable Format
Ten-Minute Play Script	25%	Week 04	Standard Industry Script
Full Scene Dramaturgical Analysis	25%	Week 08	Scene Breakdown & Notes
Full-Length One-Act Play Manuscript	40%	Week 11	Complete One-Act Script
Table Read Workshop Feedback	10%	Continuous	In-Class Table Read Critique

WEEKLY TERM SCHEDULE & READING REQUIREMENTS

Timeline	Technical Topic Focus	Assigned Readings & Docs
Week 01	Module 01: Dramatic Action & Aristotle Poetics	Aristotle (Ch. 1–6)
Week 02	Module 02: Character Objective, Obstacle, Motivation	Stanislavski (Ch. 3–5)
Week 03	Module 03: Dialogue Subtext and Exposition Strategy	Egri (Ch. 2)
Week 04	Module 04: Dramatic Structure: Three-Act and Arc	Castagno (Ch. 1 & 2)
Week 05	Module 05: Henrik Ibsen & Realist Social Drama	Ibsen (A Doll's House)
Week 06	Module 06: Anton Chekhov & Atmosphere	Chekhov (The Cherry Orchard)
Week 07	Module 07: Bertolt Brecht & Epic Alienation	Brecht (1948)
Week 08	Module 08: Theatre of the Absurd	Beckett (Waiting for Godot); Esslin (Ch. 1)
Week 09	Module 09: Contemporary Monologues and Voice	Vogel (Ch. 4)
Week 10	Module 10: Staged Reading Workshop Rehearsals	Actor Table Read Protocols
Week 11	Module 11: Final Staged Reading Performance	Festival Script Showcase